



IIRSM ELEARNING COURSE APPROVAL SUBMISSION

International Institute of Risk and Safety Management · eLearning Course Approval Scheme

SECTION 1 | COURSE OVERVIEW

Course Title	Chainsaw Maintenance & Cross Cutting — Vocational Safety Theory
Awarding / Approval Body	IIRSM (International Institute of Risk and Safety Management)
Provider	Overleaf Publishers Ltd · chainsawcourses.com
Qualification Alignment	NPTC/City & Guilds Unit 0039-20 (Chainsaw Maintenance & Cross Cutting) — theoretical underpinning and gateway to NPTC practical assessment
Level	Level 2 (equivalent) — vocational knowledge and understanding
Delivery Mode	Online eLearning — Progressive Web Application (PWA), device-locked, video-streamed
Duration	Approximately 6–8 hours of guided learning across 7 sequential modules
Assessment	7 module quizzes (80% pass threshold each) + 45-question mock examination
Entry Requirements	No formal prerequisites. Learners must be aged 18 or over. Basic literacy and numeracy required. No prior chainsaw experience necessary — course is suitable for both complete beginners and those refreshing existing knowledge before practical assessment
Target Learner	Arboricultural and forestry professionals seeking NPTC theoretical preparation; landowners; groundworkers; anyone required to demonstrate theoretical chainsaw competence before booking NPTC practical assessment
Certification	IIRSM-approved digital certificate of completion issued automatically on passing all module quizzes and the 45-question mock examination. Certificate confirms theoretical competence to support NPTC assessment centre booking. No expiry — certificate reflects knowledge at date of completion; learners are advised to repeat the course if more than 3 years have elapsed
Cost	£165 + VAT (£198.00 inc. VAT) — includes lifetime platform access, AI mock examiner, built-in inspection and risk assessment tools, Overleaf Chainsaw Manual reference, and gateway to NPTC practical assessment booking
Version	1.4 · July 2026

SECTION 2 | AUTHOR & INSTRUCTOR CREDENTIALS

	The course has been authored, developed, and is delivered under the supervision of a practising chainsaw professional holding the following NPTC City & Guilds certificates of competence. These qualifications provide the practical authority and subject-matter expertise underpinning all course content, assessment items, and the companion Overleaf Chainsaw Manual.
NPTC Qualifications	City & Guilds certificates of competence held: 0039-20 · 0039-21 · 0039-22 · 0039-23 · 0039-24 · 0039-31 · 0039-32 · 0039-33 · 0039-37 · 0039-38
CPD Status	Author holds current CPD membership with IIRSM and engages in ongoing professional development in chainsaw safety and vocational eLearning design
Platform Development	Full-stack eLearning platform designed, developed, and operated by the author — Progressive Web Application with device-locked access, Vimeo video streaming, and automated assessment
Reference Text	Course content cross-referenced against the Overleaf Chainsaw Manual (published reference text), current HSE/FISA guidance series, and applicable UK legislation

SECTION 3 | LEARNER PATHWAY — GATEWAY TO NPTC PRACTICAL ASSESSMENT

The Chainsaw Courses eLearning platform is designed as the theoretical preparation stage in the learner's journey toward full NPTC chainsaw competence. Completion of this course demonstrates to NPTC-approved assessment centres that the learner has achieved the underpinning knowledge required to attempt the practical assessment.

STAGE	DESCRIPTION
1 — Purchase & Activate	Learner purchases via chainsawcourses.com; receives a unique Activation Code bonded to their device on first use. Digital liability waiver signed on activation.
2 — Complete 7 Sequential Modules	Learner watches each video module in full (6–8 hours total). Each module locks until the previous one is passed. Modules cover PPE, first aid, risk assessment, hazards, emergency planning, legislation, and chainsaw safety features.
3 — Pass Module Quizzes	80% pass threshold on each of the 7 module quizzes. Unlimited retries permitted. Progress is saved automatically so learners can return across multiple sessions.
4 — Pass Mock Examination	45-question randomised mock examination (AI-assisted or standard). 80% pass threshold. 24-hour cooling-off period between retakes.
5 — Receive IIRSM Certificate	IIRSM-approved certificate of theoretical competence issued automatically on platform completion. Certificate includes learner name, date, and course reference.
6 — Book NPTC Practical Assessment	Learner presents their IIRSM certificate to a NPTC/City & Guilds approved assessment centre to book Unit 0039-20 practical assessment. The eLearning certificate demonstrates theoretical readiness.

Built-in tools supporting practical readiness — available throughout the learner's platform access:

- Pre-start and pre-use Inspection Checklist — mirrors the daily inspection required before practical assessment
- Dynamic Risk Assessment tool — GPS-located, records site hazards using the same framework assessed at NPTC level
- AI Chainsaw Manual Examiner — interactive mock assessment restricted to chainsaw safety topics; provides immediate explanatory feedback
- Biosecurity & Hazard Map — illustrative reference for statutory containment zones (OPM, ash dieback, etc.)
- Chain Identification Chart — reference tool for the appendix content examined in the written element of NPTC assessment



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SECTION 4 | LEARNING OUTCOMES & ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

The course is structured across seven sequential video modules, each mapped to a discrete learning outcome. Learners must complete each module video in full and achieve 80% or higher on the associated module quiz before the next module unlocks. A final summative examination of 45 randomised questions is required for certification.

MODULE	LEARNING OUTCOME
Equipment List	Identify and describe the personal protective equipment (PPE) and tools required for safe chainsaw operation, including chainsaw classification, bar length selection, and EN protection standards.
PPE & First Aid	Demonstrate knowledge of appropriate PPE standards and first-aid procedures relevant to chainsaw injury, including tourniquet application, wound management, and emergency services protocol.
5 Steps to Risk Assessment	Apply the HSE five-step risk assessment framework to chainsaw operations, identifying hazards, evaluating risk levels, and selecting appropriate control measures.
Hazards & Risks	Identify site-specific hazards and evaluate risk levels using likelihood and severity matrices, producing a documented dynamic risk assessment suitable for professional operational use.
Emergency Planning Information	Develop and communicate an emergency action plan for chainsaw operations on site, including site access for emergency services, nearest medical facility, and first aider identification.
Law & Legislation	Describe the legal framework governing chainsaw use including PUWER 1998, MHSWR 1999, Control of Noise at Work Regulations 2005, Control of Vibration at Work Regulations 2005, and HSE guidance.
Chainsaw Safety Features	Identify and explain the function of all primary chainsaw safety features and their activation mechanisms, including chain brake, hand guard, chain catcher, anti-vibration system, and throttle interlock.

SECTION 5 | COURSE CONTENT — DETAILED SYLLABUS



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TOPIC AREA	CONTENT COVERED
Chainsaw anatomy & classification	Bar length, CC rating, chain pitch and gauge, drive sprocket, guide bar lubrication system, oil pump, chain tensioner, safety features (chain brake, hand guard, chain catcher, anti-vibration, throttle interlock)
Personal Protective Equipment	Chainsaw trousers (ISO 11393-2, Classes 1–3); chainsaw boots (ISO 17249); gloves (EN 381-7); forestry helmet (EN 397 or EN 12492); eye protection (ISO 16321); hearing protection (EN 352-3)
First Aid — chainsaw specific	Wound classification; application of tourniquets and haemostatic dressings; shock management; calling emergency services; communicating site location (OS National Grid reference, What3Words)
Risk Assessment (5 steps)	Hazard identification; who might be harmed and how; risk evaluation (likelihood × severity); control measures (hierarchy of controls); review and monitoring
Dynamic Risk Assessment	Site-specific hazard assessment; site description; emergency planning; exclusion zones; lone-working protocols; likelihood and severity rating (1–5 matrix) for chainsaw-specific hazards
Emergency Planning	Site access for emergency vehicles; nearest A&E/trauma centre; nearest AED; first aider on site; emergency contact protocol; communication in areas of poor signal
UK Legislation	HSW Act 1974; PUWER 1998 (Reg. 9 — training requirement); MHSWR 1999 (risk assessment); PPE Regulations 2022; Control of Noise at Work Regulations 2005 (EAV/ELV); Control of Vibration at Work Regulations 2005 (HAV); RIDDOR 2013; LOLER 1998
Biosecurity	Oak Processionary Moth (OPM); ash dieback (<i>Hymenoscyphus fraxineus</i>); spruce bark beetle; sudden oak death; equipment decontamination between sites; reporting obligations under Plant Health (Forestry) Order 2005
Chain maintenance	Chain sharpening angles (top-plate, side-plate, raker depth); file sizes by pitch; chain types (full-chisel, semi-chisel, low-profile); chain identification by pitch, gauge, and drive-link count
Safe systems of work	Pre-start inspection checklist; manual handling task assessment; exclusion zones (twice the length of the product or 5 m, whichever is greater); working alone policy; fatigue management; refuelling procedure



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SECTION 6 | ASSESSMENT METHODOLOGY

Assessment on the Chainsaw Courses platform is designed to be valid, reliable, fair, and sufficient to confirm theoretical competence at the level required to support NPTC 0039-20 practical assessment preparation.

ASSESSMENT ELEMENT	SPECIFICATION
Assessment format	Multiple-choice questions (MCQ) with four answer options per question
Question bank size	Minimum 10 questions per module (70+ module questions total); 45-question mock examination drawn from full bank
Randomisation	Questions and answer option order randomised on each attempt to prevent memorisation of answer sequences
Pass threshold	80% correct answers required for each module quiz and for the mock examination
Sequential gating	Each module quiz must be passed ("e80%) before the subsequent module video unlocks. Module video must be watched in full before the quiz is accessible
Retries	Unlimited retries permitted for all module quizzes and the mock examination. No cooling-off period between attempts
Results recording	All quiz and examination results are recorded automatically to the learner's progress record with timestamp; accessible at any time from the Training Dashboard
Anti-malpractice	Device-locking (one device per Activation Code); dynamic video watermarking (learner name + email, repositioning every 60 seconds); behavioural review for anomalous completion patterns
Feedback	Immediate right/wrong feedback provided on each question after module quiz submission; mock examination feedback provided on completion

SECTION 7 | QUALITY ASSURANCE AND COMPLIANCE

QA ELEMENT	DETAIL
Content review cycle	Full content audit conducted annually against current HSE/FISA guidance and UK legislation; triggered reviews within 30 days of any new publication or legislative change



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Internal verification	All assessment items reviewed by Internal Verifier for accuracy, currency, validity, and alignment with learning outcomes — see Internal Verification Policy
Learner feedback	Module feedback ratings collected at end of each module; reviewed monthly; aggregate data reported to IIRSM annually
Complaints and appeals	Formal complaints and appeals procedures in place — see Complaints Procedure and Appeals Policy
Data protection	UK GDPR compliant; ICO registered; learner data retained for 3 years — see Data Protection Policy
Accessibility	Platform designed for WCAG 2.1 AA compatibility; reasonable adjustments available on request — see Reasonable Adjustments Policy
Safeguarding	Adult-only platform (18+); age verification at purchase and activation; designated safeguarding contact in post — see Safeguarding Policy
Policies published	All governance policies available to learners via the in-platform Documents Library

SECTION 8 | TECHNICAL PLATFORM SPECIFICATION

COMPONENT	SPECIFICATION
Platform type	Progressive Web Application (PWA) — accessible via any modern browser; no app store installation required
Access control	Unique Activation Code per learner; bonded to single device via UUID stored in browser localStorage
Video delivery	Vimeo Pro — domain-restricted embed; dynamic on-screen watermark overlay (learner name + email)
Database	PostgreSQL — learner progress, quiz results, waiver, inspection, and risk assessment records stored securely
Authentication	Token-based session management; activation code + device ID + user ID triple validation on all API calls
Infrastructure	Hosted on Replit cloud infrastructure; HTTPS throughout; auto-scaling; UK/EU data residency
Assessment engine	Server-side randomised question selection from PostgreSQL question bank; automated marking and results recording



AI mock examiner	OpenAI GPT-4o via Replit AI proxy; restricted to chainsaw safety topics only; falls back gracefully if AI is unavailable
PDF generation	Server-generated signed waivers, inspection reports, risk assessments, and completion certificates — consistent orange branding
Accessibility features	Keyboard navigation; screen-reader compatible markup; responsive design (mobile, tablet, desktop)

SECTION 9 | DECLARATION

I confirm that the information contained in this submission is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge. The course content has been developed with reference to current HSE and FISA guidance, applicable UK legislation, and the practical experience gained through the NPTC qualifications listed in Section 2. I understand that IIRSM may request further information or a demonstration of the platform as part of the approval process.

Submitted by: Overleaf Publishers Ltd
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